



Ben Affleck next Batman

That's right. Warner Bros. has confirmed their choice for the next flick in 2015. Surprised? <http://dgit.in/1dyQ3Aj>

New drug mimics exercise

A drug known as SR9009, currently being developed at Scripps Research Institute can make you enjoy the benefits of exercise <http://dgit.in/19Bsogq>

Our Opera moment

One of the stalwarts of the browser world, Opera holds a special place among power users. The browser has undergone many transformations recently, and to catch up on the latest and greatest from Opera, we had a chat with **Sebastian Baberowski, Product Management Director (Desktop), Opera Software**. Following is an excerpt from our exclusive interview:

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For anyone not using Opera browser right now, what would be the most compelling reason for them to switch to Opera?

So Opera is now lighter with our compact source which is one of the reasons and we also have the main features, which are speed dial, we group tasks (which is a completely new idea and I think it's quite great) and discover. We are switching from webkit to whole new engine and our goal is to have more time to focus on the really cool things, cool features for our users to really help them in their daily work. So over the time I expect that we will have a lot more of the great features and hope that we will continue to do what Opera did in the past. If you look at the current browsers, whatever browsers you want to look at like IE, Chrome, Safari and Firefox. The main functionality of those browsers are taken from Opera, so we were the first browser with an ad blocker, integrated search and speed dial. So we simply want to continue doing that and we want to be the leader in the innovation of browser technology.

Would you elaborate more about Opera 15's "Discovery mode"?

We have a dedicated engineering team for making that feature as it is still evolving and we are looking to adding a few more things. Our marketing and PR teams around the globe points us to the right content, from the tech point of view it is quite a good feature, and we constantly look for duplicates. For example, when the new pope was elected, there was a lot of content to catch on because every portal was saying the same about the new and old pope. Our team was happy trying to



Sebastian Baberowski, Product MD (Desktop), Opera Software

look for original content source and eliminating duplicates.

Opera's had issues with Google services in the past, they don't work as well as on Chrome, for e.g. Any particular reason why this seems to be happening?

I'm happy to report that we don't have these issues on Opera 15 because we now use the same engine as Chrome (Chromium and WebKit) so all services should work as normal and this also is a big reason for us to switch from our old engine (Presto) which used to have problems rendering those pages because we were the only browser using that engine and it is not accurate. So yeah, I can tell you that we used to have those issues and now that we don't have them anymore.

You mentioned briefly about how Opera has been pioneering tech that other browsers have duplicated. Can you talk about

them and other aspects that make Opera better than most browsers on the market?

So yeah I think that I said about a few features that we have now, and also about the features which we are about to include like Opera Sync (for syncing things) which is not a new feature since it is already present in Firefox and Chrome. But we are going to continue in that market and get on to cloud for the browser. We are really doing some research and spending a lot of time in the human interaction design and UI design and so on to make this browser really cool and really usable. Unlike Mozilla, Google or Apple, we are mainly a browser company and focusing more on those areas than other companies do.

So who do you think is Opera's core audience, is it geek users or the masses?

We were just working on targeting the browser and so on. Currently I can tell you that we have a lot of geeky users, it's nothing new. I think for the new Opera, Opera 15, the target user is one who wants to have a choice. It's not like for the masses because we don't have geek marketing forces that Google has and so on. I think, not technical but a user who wants to have a choice who can choose intentionally and download and use us. Then recommend to other fans.

So from Opera 15 the geekiness of the browser is reducing?

So the idea behind Opera 15 is to have a browser which feels good for the power users. So we want to have powerful browser which can please the power users but we also want a browser that can be user by normal users and not just geeky users. This is quite a hard task to do, you know join those things, but so far I think we are good at that and we are progressing well. 